

Making a might-want-to-do list is the only way I know to get a handle on "but what will I do?"

The time to start your list is right now, while you're still working.

A TO-DO LIST

Pilots check out their planes with lists. Housewives shop with them, and a certain kind of boy refers to them when building model cars. If you're like me your to-do list at the office has become a should-do list, as in "things I should do but really don't want to do." Your list tells you how far behind you are. You charge around the office all day like Walter Payton. But at the end of the day your to-do list stretches just as long or longer. The list reminds you that last summer's time-management course changed your behavior hardly at all.

But no matter how much you may hate your to-do list at work, I believe a good list in retirement helps chart your course. Imagine yourself retired, sitting in front of a TV rerun of *My Mother the Car*. You're as absorbed as a 7-year-old in church. You're desperate for something to do but nothing comes to you. The solution is to pull out the to-do list, choose something, and get cracking. Remember, you've listed the things you *want* to do, not things you have to do or should do.

Make a to-do list

The list should be as specific as possible. But settle for general ideas when specifics don't come to mind. You'll have plenty of time for specifics later.

Your list may look something like mine: ride bikes, learn yoga and TM, play golf, cook. Set up a daily routine, keep a notebook, read, go to the library, write a new novel, edit the old novel, write a business article for a newspaper, write